

Post-incident review PIR-2025-038

Data Warehouse: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 28 May 2025, Data Warehouse experienced degraded latency in staging (AU Southeast) for about 12 minutes. A scripted sign-in probe started failing from two regions. Investigation found that a race condition in the session cache returned tokens belonging to expired sessions.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw degraded latency for about 12 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:01 First signal received.
- 09:25 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:41 Likely cause identified.
- 10:21 Mitigation applied.
- 10:48 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a race condition in the session cache returned tokens belonging to expired sessions.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.